The 6:15

SUNDAY · OCTOBER 25, 2026 NO. 31

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · WEEKEND FORMAT

Today	World Series Game 3, Brewers at Rays, Tampa Bay, tonight — Brewers lead 2-0 after Saturday's 5-4 Game 2 win in Milwaukee.
Next 10 days	Tue-Wed 10/27-28 FOMC (hold heavily favored; third-party trackers show cut/hike odds in the 8%-16% range, not independently confirmed via CME this run); Thu 10/29 PCE (Sept.) & Q3 GDP advance, 8:30a ET; Sat 11/1 OPEC+ meets; Tue 11/3 midterms.

Microsoft/Alphabet/Amazon/Meta and Coca-Cola/Boeing earnings dates **not verified this run**.

METRICS · FRIDAY CLOSE, WEEKEND FORMAT

Oil / rates	No new session since Friday's settle: Brent $116.72 (+3.14%, war-high) / WTI $103.27 (+3.82%); spread ~$13.45. 2Y 4.69% / 10Y 5.00% / 30Y 5.33% — all Fri. 10/23 close, unchanged.
Equities / other	Dow 52,215.16 / S&P 7,623.68 / Nasdaq Comp. 25,955.34 / VIX 19.45 — Fri. close, unchanged. Gold $4,007.90 (-1.29%); DXY 101.60 (-0.05%), Fri. close. Gas **not confirmed as of press time**.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Status	Closed to commercial shipping, Day 238 **(single-sourced)**
Transits	4 vessels, Oct. 18 (PortWatch) vs. 85/day baseline — 7 days stale
Strikes, 24h	None new; Sat.'s 2-supertanker mine claim still **uncorroborated** by UKMTO as of 10:17 UTC Sun.
Risk screen	straits.live swapped its dark-tanker % for a flagged-vessel screen: 25 high-risk/178 moderate-risk of 1,926 tracked, 24h **(methodology change;**

	not comparable to Fri.'s 72.0%; site marks its own AIS feed stale)
War-risk premium	~32x pre-crisis, dated Oct. 7 — 18 days stale
Indices	Crisis Pressure 88±10 (Extreme, flat); Escalation Forecast 62±11 (High, +1)
Market odds	Polymarket, unchanged: <1% by 10/31, 6% by 11/30, 12% by 12/31

Methodology: IRGC claims (Iranian state media, uncorroborated), UKMTO (no matching advisory this period), PortWatch (lagged AIS transit count, stale) and straits.live's flagged-vessel screen (methodology just changed, AIS feed marked stale) measure different things over different windows — never averaged or differenced here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over, offseason; no reported moves in the last 24 hours.
Knicks	0-2; no game Sat.; next game date **not confirmed this run**.
Northwestern	Beat Rutgers 42-14 Sat.; now 6-1, 3-1 Big Ten, bowl-eligible.

LEAD

A SECOND NIGHT, STILL NO CORROBORATION

Markets stay shut on Friday's war-high close while Saturday's mine claim goes unanswered, and Hormuz's own risk tracker changes how it counts the evidence

No trading session has intervened since Friday's close, so Friday's levels stand as the last verified prints heading into FOMC week: Brent's $116.72 settle (+3.14%, the highest close of the seven-month war) and WTI's $103.27 (+3.82%), both per oilprice.com and straits.live, which agree on the figures; Treasury's 2-, 10- and 30-year at 4.69%, 5.00% and 5.33%; DXY at 101.60 (-0.05%, investing.com); gold at $4,007.90 (-1.29%, Yahoo Finance). [fact, continuity] Nothing here has moved because nothing has traded —

the gap between Friday's close and Monday's open is this issue's real subject.

Into that quiet came Saturday's claim: Iran's IRGC Navy said overnight Friday-into-Saturday that two supertankers were struck and disabled by naval mines in the strait. As of straits.live's own 10:17 UTC Sunday timestamp, neither UKMTO nor any flag state had corroborated it — now well past 24 hours outstanding, and consistent with the pattern this brief has tracked through the week: IRGC mine and strike claims have gone unmatched by a specific UKMTO advisory more often than not. [fact/continuity, flag] Thursday's separate seven-vessel claim, which President Trump branded fabricated, also remains unresolved either way.

Something did move on the Hormuz dashboard overnight, but it's the measurement, not the war. straits.live's page no longer publishes the dark-tanker percentage this brief has carried for weeks (Friday's reading was 72.0%); in its place is a "flagged-vessel screen" showing 25 high-risk and 178 moderate-risk vessels of 1,926 tracked in the Gulf over 24 hours, and the page now marks its own AIS feed stale. [fact, NEW, flag] Read: that is not evidence that evasive shipping behavior improved or worsened over the weekend. It is evidence the tracker changed its own methodology mid-crisis, which means Friday's 72.0% and today's new figures cannot be compared, and this issue is where that particular series' continuity breaks. [read]

The two indices straits.live does keep on a consistent basis moved only fractionally: Crisis Pressure held at 88±10 (Extreme), and the Escalation Forecast rose a point to 62±11 (High), reversing Friday's one-point dip. [fact, continuity] The VLCC war-risk premium this brief has tracked at roughly 32x pre-crisis is now 18 days stale, dated to Oct. 7 — the instrument that would normally reprice fastest on a

genuine mine strike hasn't published a new read in nearly three weeks, which says something about how thin actual underwriting activity in the strait has become even as claims continue. [fact/read, flag]

Read: a closed market cannot test a claim the way a trading session can. Friday's selloff already priced in one unconfirmed account; Saturday's claim arrives with no price discovery available to accept or reject it before Monday's Asia open, the first session that will. [read] Watch: whether Tokyo or Hong Kong extend Friday's risk-off tape at Sunday evening ET's open; whether UKMTO or a flag state corroborates or debunks the new mine claim before then; whether PortWatch's Oct. 18 transit count — now seven days stale — updates at all before the Fed meets Tuesday-Wednesday; and whether straits.live restores a dark-tanker comparison or keeps the new flagged-vessel format.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the new mine claim and the dashboard's methodology change (Lead), little else moved. Foreign Minister Araghchi's most recent on-record position remains Oct. 18's restatement that Tehran is "ready for dialogue based on mutual respect and credible guarantees" — softer in tone than September's seven-day reopening plan, which President Trump rejected as unacceptable and which has had no disclosed US response since Sept. 30. [fact, continuity] Polymarket's odds on a return to normal transit are unchanged across all three horizons it prices: under 1% by Oct. 31, 6% by Nov. 30, 12% by Dec. 31. [fact, continuity, single-sourced] OPEC+ meets Nov. 1 to set December output after three straight months holding the group's combined quota at 31.01 million b/d; no delegate has

commented publicly on this week's mine claims ahead of that meeting. [fact, continuity] Methodology: IRGC claims (Iranian state media, no independent corroboration), UKMTO (no matching advisory this period), PortWatch (lagged AIS strait-transit count, now stale) and straits.live's flagged-vessel screen (methodology just changed, AIS feed marked stale) measure different things over different windows — never averaged or differenced here.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over; eliminated Oct. 7, swept 3-0 by Tampa Bay in the ALDS.
Knicks	0-2; idle Saturday after Friday's 107-103 loss at Boston.
Northwestern	6-1, 3-1 Big Ten; beat Rutgers 42-14 Sat. at Ryan Field, now bowl-eligible.
World Series	Brewers beat Rays 5-4 in Game 2 Sat. in Milwaukee; lead series 2-0. Game 3 tonight in Tampa Bay.

Continuity. Politics, Economics, Business, Technology and Geopolitics (Russia-Ukraine) are cut this weekend issue — markets haven't traded since Friday's close (covered in the Lead), and nothing new moved on the others since issue No. 30. Watch for next issue: corroboration or debunking of Saturday's mine claim; whether straits.live restores a dark-tanker comparison; PortWatch's transit count past Oct. 18; Monday's Asia open and US market open; World Series Game 3 and Knicks' next game.

Unverified figures are marked in red: Saturday's IRGC two-supertanker mine claim; the new flagged-vessel screen figures (methodology changed, AIS feed marked stale); AAA retail gas price; FOMC cut/hike odds (third-party trackers disagree, CME not independently confirmed this run); Big Tech and Coca-Cola/Boeing earnings dates; Knicks' next game date. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.